ATHARVA NALAWADE

AI Engineer / Full Stack Developer — RAG Pipelines · LLM Integration · AI-Assisted Development · MERN · FastAPI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI Engineer and Full Stack Developer with hands-on experience designing and shipping AI-powered platforms end to end — from document ingestion and chunking through embedding generation, vector storage, retrieval, and LLM-based inference. Built a production RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation) pipeline using IBM Docling for document parsing, Gemini for embeddings/vectorization and LLM inference, a TensorFlow-based proctoring system for real-time monitoring, and an AI resume filtering engine for automated candidate screening. Comfortable across the AI engineering stack — prompt engineering, LLM integration, vector search and semantic retrieval, model evaluation, and API-based orchestration of LLM workflows. Works daily with AI-assisted development tools such as Claude (Claude Code), GitHub Copilot, and Cursor to design, code, debug, and refactor faster without compromising code quality. Equally strong in backend development (Node.js, FastAPI), REST API design, and relational/NoSQL database design, with a track record of shipping reliable, production-ready AI features in a fast-moving product environment.

CORE AI ENGINEERING SKILLS

- Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG): document parsing & chunking, embedding generation, vector storage, semantic search, and context-aware retrieval for LLM question-answering systems
- LLM Integration: designing and consuming LLM APIs (Google Gemini) for classification, scoring, summarization, and structured-output generation
- Prompt Engineering: writing and iterating on prompts for consistent, structured, production-grade LLM outputs; handling edge cases and reducing hallucination in downstream tasks
- Applied Machine Learning: TensorFlow-based real-time computer vision (face detection, object/phone detection) for proctoring and monitoring use cases
- AI-Assisted Software Development: using Claude (Claude Code), GitHub Copilot, and Cursor across the SDLC — code generation, debugging, refactoring, code review, and test writing — to increase engineering velocity
- Data Pipelines for AI: building ingestion pipelines that convert unstructured documents (PDF, PPT, audio) into structured, embeddable, and searchable data

WORK EXPERIENCE

Full Stack Developer | Quodeck Technologies Private Limited January 2025 – Present

- Designed and built an AI-powered document processing / RAG pipeline end to end: used IBM Docling to parse and chunk PDFs, PPTs, and audio transcripts into clean, structured text units suitable for embedding
- Generated vector embeddings for parsed document chunks using Gemini, and stored/indexed them to enable fast semantic search and context retrieval for downstream LLM-based question answering
- Engineered prompts and orchestration logic to feed retrieved context into Gemini for accurate, grounded LLM responses, reducing irrelevant or hallucinated answers in the document Q&A workflow
- Developed an AI resume filtering application using Gemini LLM APIs to evaluate and score resumes against job descriptions based on skills, keywords, and experience match, streamlining candidate shortlisting
- Built an AI-powered proctoring application using TensorFlow for real-time face detection, phone detection, and tab-switch monitoring to ensure assessment integrity
- Used AI engineering tools — Claude (Claude Code), GitHub Copilot, and Cursor — throughout the development lifecycle for code generation, debugging, refactoring, and test writing, improving delivery speed on AI and full-stack features
- Implemented real-time alerts and monitoring dashboards for online assessments; developed full-stack features using React, Node.js, Express.js, TypeScript, MongoDB, FastAPI, and PostgreSQL
- Used FastAPI with Alembic for database migrations and PostgreSQL for structured data storage; containerized services with Docker and deployed via Nginx on DigitalOcean
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams using Git for version control and Jest for testing, and reviewed AI-assisted code contributions to maintain quality and consistency across the codebase

PROJECTS

Uber-like Ride Booking Web Application

- Real-time ride booking platform with Socket.IO live updates, OTP-based authentication, and Google Maps API for live tracking and routing

- Implemented driver-rider matching logic, live location broadcasting, and trip-state management using Socket.IO for a smooth real-time booking experience
- Tech: React, Node.js, Express.js, MongoDB, Socket.IO, Google Maps API

Relaydesk · AI RAG Support Reply Assistant

- Built a production RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation) customer-support reply assistant: FastAPI backend with pgvector semantic + keyword retrieval over brand policy documents and a React frontend, deployed live
- Implemented confidence-gated generation via OpenRouter LLM API, guardrails to block unsafe refund promises against order data, and deterministic fallback logic for LLM outages, ensuring reliable production behavior
- Tech: React, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, pgvector | Live: ragllmdatastraw.vercel.app

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- AI / ML: TensorFlow, Google Gemini API, RAG Pipelines, IBM Docling, Vector Embeddings & Vectorization, Vector Search, LLM Integration, Prompt Engineering, AI Agents
- AI Engineering Tools: Claude (Claude Code), GitHub Copilot, Cursor, AI Pair Programming, AI-Assisted Development
- Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Java, PHP
- Frontend: React.js, Next.js, HTML, CSS, Tailwind CSS
- Backend: Node.js, Express.js, FastAPI
- Databases: MongoDB, MySQL, PostgreSQL
- Tools & Platforms: Git, Docker, Nginx, Jest

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Grand Finalist — Smart India Hackathon 2023: selected among thousands of teams nationwide; solved a real-world problem statement within a 36-hour national hackathon

EDUCATION

- Master of Computer Applications (MCA) — NCRD's Sterling Institute of Management Studies | CGPA: 8.70
- Bachelor of Science in Computer Science — Mulund College of Commerce, University of Mumbai | CGPA: 8.39